

PRODUCT TEARDOWN

New User Onboarding



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Overview



About the company

Workflow automation platform combining AI-powered steps with human-in-the-loop checkpoints. Built on the belief that human judgment should be built in, not bolted on.



Business model

Usage-based pricing (steps + AI credits) with no seat-based gating. All plans include all integrations — no "pay extra for connectors" model.



Competitive landscape

Zapier: 7,000+ integrations, legacy.
Make.com: Power-user, complex UI.
n8n: Dev-first, self-hostable.
Lindy/Gumloop: AI-native competitors.



Positioning

The automation tool for teams where humans stay in the loop — easier than Make, smarter than Zapier, built for collaboration.



User
Personas
(1/4)

Ria Singh, 26, Female

About

Occupation: Sales Manager SaaS Startup

Head Location: Bangalore, India

Core Needs & Goals

Automate lead enrichment by integrating data sources, validating contacts, appending key data, scoring prospects, and syncing with CRM to improve targeting, personalization, and sales efficiency.

Pain Points

Personalized outreach feels fake because it relies on basic tagging instead of deeper insights. Manually researching 500 prospects per week is not feasible or scalable.



User Personas

Aryan Roy, 24, Male

About

Occupation: Admin Ecommerce Business

Location: Bangalore, India

Core Needs & Goals

Analyze unstructured PDF invoices and verify extracted data against the database for accuracy and consistency, with the goal of reducing manual effort, minimizing errors, and improving operational efficiency.

Pain Points

The team spends around 20 hours each week manually reading PDF invoices and entering data into an ERP system.





User Journey Map



User
Journey Map
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Awareness

Word-of-mouth, ProductHunt, Twitter/X. "Zapier with AI" resonates.



Sign Up

~30s with Google SSO. Clean, intuitive dashboard. Low friction.



First Playbook

Drag-and-drop trigger + steps. "Playbook" visual metaphor.

FRICTION POINT # 1

Conditional logic complexity



'Aha Moment'

(~30-60 mins). Inserts first HitL step. Workflow pauses, waits for approval.



Expansion

One workflow runs, users build for other processes. Slack/CRM/Email.

FRICTION POINT # 2

Learning curve for multi-step logic



Adoption

Scaling to large teams (25+). Moving from solo to team plan.

FRICTION POINT # 4

Integration library limits

• Stage ★ 'Aha Moment' ■ Friction Point



Key Learnings



Learning
&
Improvement
(3/4)



Frictionless, "No-Tour" Onboarding

THE DESIGN

Dropping users directly into a clean canvas or template library via Google SSO, entirely bypassing forced product tours or popup tutorials.

THE WHY

Accelerates time-to-value. By trusting the user's intelligence and reducing upfront friction, Relay builds immediate goodwill and gets them to their first workflow faster.



Mental-Model Mapping

THE DESIGN

Using terms like "Playbooks" (instead of workflows) and explicitly naming features "Human-in-the-Loop," "Approvals," or "Tasks."

THE WHY

Drastically reduces cognitive load. It masks complex automation logic behind vocabulary that perfectly mirrors how business teams actually talk about their daily operations.



Recommendation to Improve



Learning

&

Improvement

(3/4)



External Stakeholder Approvals

The inability to involve non-Relay users in approval steps is a hard blocker for many real-world processes.

THE FIX

Allow HitL steps to send a *magic link* via email to an external person (no login required) with simple approve/reject UI.



Versioning & Rollback

Version control and workflow history to roll back changes would be a significant improvement.

THE IMPACT

Removes the fear of "breaking a live workflow," which is currently a real barrier to iteration for business-critical automations.



AI Output Error Handling

Workflows can stumble when AI output doesn't perfectly match a schema.

RESILIENCE

Implementing "retry with adjusted prompt" or "fallback to human review" would make automations far more resilient.



Key Metric

1. Weekly Active Playbooks (WAP) [North Star]

WHY IT MATTERS: It's the ultimate measure of realized value. Proves automation is embedded in routine rather than just a dusty experiment.

2. Activation Rate (%first run in 7 days) [Acquisition]

WHY IT MATTERS: Tells you if your UI and onboarding are reducing friction. Early "wins" are critical to prevent abandonment.

3. HitL Step Adoption Rate [Engagement]

WHY IT MATTERS: This is the product's moat. Adopting Human-in-the-Loop creates deep lock-in to Relay's specific value proposition.

4. Pro → Team Conv. Rate [Monetization]

WHY IT MATTERS: Shifts product from single-player to organizational dependency, unlocking compounding revenue growth and high NRR.

5. Workflow Error Rate [Product Health]

WHY IT MATTERS: Trust is everything. A rising error rate is the most reliable leading indicator for future churn as users revert to manual work.

